

Burak Kalafat

Software Architect | .NET & Java Backend Engineering

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Istanbul, Turkey | Europe/Istanbul

Summary

Hands-on software architect with 14+ years across banking, payments, enterprise financial software and government identity systems. Builds .NET/Java backends for digital banking, CRM and collections; modernises COBOL/mainframe systems and EOD/batch workloads.

Professional Experience

Software Architect | Innovance

January 2026 – Present | Istanbul, Turkey (Remote)

Previously: Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | May 2024 – December 2025

- Modernise Akbank COBOL/mainframe banking and payment systems into .NET and Java backends, with hands-on implementation primarily in Java 21; analyse legacy business rules and shape backend architecture.
- Work on mission-critical EOD and batch modernisation, analysing job dependencies and workload orchestration for scheduled banking processes.
- Designed and developed an enterprise GitHub Copilot plugin for the Architecture organisation, packaging reusable guidance, agent/sub-agent workflows and engineering standards.
- Built repository- and database-oriented Copilot workflows and reusable engineering knowledge to support AI-assisted SDLC and spec-driven development across teams.
- Developed internet and mobile banking services for Türkiye Finans, implementing ASP.NET MVC/WCF backends with SQL Server and unit tests.

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | insightsoftware

September 2022 – April 2024 | North Carolina, USA (Remote)

- Implemented C#/.NET Core backend features for enterprise financial software within an international remote engineering team.
- Contributed to backend architecture and feature design, connecting technical decisions with hands-on implementation.

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | OBSS

September 2017 – September 2022 | Istanbul, Turkey

- Led Halkbank mobile banking backend migration to .NET Core and Clean Architecture, restructuring the legacy .NET Framework implementation.
- Applied asynchronous programming and thread optimisation to banking request handling; built REST APIs with EF Core and SQL Server.
- Used Repository/Unit of Work patterns and Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines for backend delivery.
- Owned code reviews and mentored Türkiye Finans developers, defining coding standards for WinForms/WCF customer applications.
- Led Akbank payment campaign development with C#, Java/Spring, TypeScript, Knockout.js and Oracle 12c.

Professional Experience · Continued

Java Developer | TÜBİTAK

January 2017 – September 2017 | Kocaeli, Turkey

- Implemented Java passport personalisation software, writing EAC/SAC security data to smartcard chips through APDU commands for government identity systems.

.NET Developer | VakıfBank

August 2013 – January 2017 | Istanbul, Turkey

- Reworked VakıfBank CRM and collections applications towards service-oriented architecture, using WPF/MVVM, WCF and Oracle 11g/PL/SQL.

Part-Time .NET Developer | VeriPark

December 2012 – June 2013 | Izmir, Turkey

- Developed ASP.NET widgets for Turkcell’s SharePoint environment, contributing to portal functionality while completing the Computer Engineering degree.

Technical Skills

Banking and Modernisation

Payment systems, COBOL/mainframe modernisation, End-of-Day (EOD), Batch processing, Job dependencies, Workload orchestration

Architecture and Design

Clean Architecture, Domain-Driven Design (DDD), Distributed systems, Service-oriented architecture, Repository, Unit of Work, Facade, Strategy

Enterprise AI Engineering

GitHub Copilot Enterprise, AI-assisted SDLC, Agentic development, Spec-Driven Development (SDD), Developer enablement, Architecture enablement

Technical Leadership and Quality

Architecture guidance, Code reviews, Mentoring, Coding standards, Unit testing, Playwright E2E testing

Training

Microservices, .NET with AWS, React

Backend Engineering

C#, .NET, .NET Core, ASP.NET MVC, REST APIs, EF Core, Asynchronous programming, WCF

Data and Integration

Oracle, SQL Server (MSSQL), PL/SQL, IBM MQ, RabbitMQ

Delivery and Platforms

Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Docker, Kubernetes

Languages and Frameworks

Java 21, Spring, TypeScript, JavaScript, WPF, WinForms, Knockout.js

Education

BSc in Computer Engineering · Ege University

Izmir, Turkey | September 2008 – June 2013

Certifications

Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate

Microsoft | Certification | March 6, 2026 | Expires March 6, 2027 | Certification overview (AI-102)

Introduction to GitHub Copilot

Microsoft Learn | Training | 2024 | Course overview

Build Microservices with .NET and Amazon Web Services · Udemy | Training | February 2024

IELTS - Band 7 · British Council | Language test | 2023

React Nanodegree Program · Udacity | Training | February 2020

Languages · Turkish: Native; English: Professional proficiency; IELTS Band 7 (2023)

Interests · Chess; LLM and RAG applications; AI-powered customer service; Travel and cultural exchange